

D923

Teaching in Middle School

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A parent volunteer who is also the PTA treasurer asks a seventh-grade teacher how another student did on the last science test. The volunteer helps in the classroom every Thursday. How should the teacher respond?

- A. Share the score, since the volunteer is a PTA officer.
- B. Share grades but not discipline records.
- C. Share freely, since grades can always be shared with school volunteers.
- D. Politely decline; grades are shared only with the student's family and staff with a legitimate educational interest.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which disclosure of a student's records is allowed without parent consent?

- A. Sharing a student's progress with the school counselor who works with that student.
- B. Posting graded tests with names on a hallway wall.
- C. Emailing grades to the student's private club coach.
- D. Telling a neighbor how the student is doing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

After an assembly on bike safety, a sixth grader shows a teacher bruises and says a family member caused them, then asks the teacher to keep it secret. The student is a strong reader. What should the teacher do?

- A. Explain that she cannot keep it secret, and report promptly to child protective services following school policy.
- B. Call the family to hear their side first.
- C. Promise to keep it secret to protect trust.
- D. Wait for more signs before acting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

What level of certainty does a teacher need before making a mandatory report of suspected abuse?

- A.** Reasonable suspicion.
- B.** A signed statement from the student.
- C.** Clear proof that abuse happened.
- D.** Permission from the principal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

An eighth grader sends a friend request to a teacher’s personal social-media account. The student’s parent is a family friend of the teacher. The request came on a Saturday. What should the teacher do?

- A.** Accept, since contact is fine as long as it is about homework.
- B.** Accept but keep the account’s posts private.
- C.** Accept, since the parent is a family friend.
- D.** Decline and keep communication with students on school-approved platforms.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

At a middle school that just installed a new front-office system, many families who speak languages other than English rarely attend conferences held at 3:00 p.m. on weekdays. What is the best response?

- A.** Send more reminder flyers in English.
- B.** Offer evening and virtual times, provide interpreters, and ask families about their child’s strengths and goals.
- C.** Rely on a single newsletter each semester.
- D.** Conclude that these families do not value education.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which is an example of two-way family communication?

- A.** A report card sent home.
- B.** A monthly class newsletter.
- C.** A teacher calls home to ask what the family sees as the student's strengths and goals.
- D.** Automatic grade-portal alerts.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A science teacher whose school has a large garden wants to work with a local water-treatment plant during a unit on water quality. The plant opened 40 years ago. Which plan uses the community resource best?

- A.** Skip it, since community partners are always a distraction in middle school.
- B.** Plan a visit or expert talk tied to the unit's questions, with preparation beforehand and data analysis afterward.
- C.** Let a company promote its products in class in exchange for supplies.
- D.** Schedule a fun trip on the last day with no link to the unit.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A teacher's evaluation, completed in a new online platform, rates questioning as "developing" because most questions ask for recall. The evaluator was a former math coach. What is the best next step?

- A.** Sign up for any available professional development.
- B.** Set a goal that by March at least 30% of questions will be higher-order, checked in recorded lessons every two weeks.
- C.** Dispute the rating before doing anything else.
- D.** Set a goal to "ask better questions."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher's growth goal reads, "Increase student discussion in my classes." What does it most need to become a SMART goal?

- A.** Approval from an administrator.
- B.** Nothing; any goal about students is already SMART.
- C.** The name of the subject taught.
- D.** A measurable target and a deadline.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A lesson on ratios, taught on a rainy Monday, went poorly: most students could not solve the final problems. The teacher's room was recently repainted. What is the most useful reflective step?

- A.** Conclude the students were not trying.
- B.** Decide it was just a bad day and move on.
- C.** Sort the student work to find where understanding broke down, then adjust the next lesson.
- D.** Wait for the next formal evaluation to find out what went wrong.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A general education teacher with 15 years of experience receives a student's IEP requiring guided notes and extended time on assignments. The teacher feels it is unfair to the other 28 students. What must the teacher do?

- A.** Treat the accommodations as optional in general education.
- B.** Provide them only when a special education teacher is present.
- C.** Provide the guided notes and extended time as written.
- D.** Apply them only on tests.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A parent volunteer ~~who is also the PTA treasurer~~ asks a seventh-grade teacher how another student did on the last science test. ~~The volunteer helps in the classroom every Thursday.~~ How should the teacher respond?

Target word: records confidentiality **Decides:** The volunteer has no legitimate educational interest in that student's record.

A	Camouflage	A PTA role gives no right to other students' records.
B	Adjacent category	Grades are protected records too.
C	Absolute language	Volunteers do not get access by default.
D	Correct	Education records are confidential.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

Which disclosure of a student's records is allowed without parent consent?

Target word: legitimate educational interest **Decides:** A school official working with the student.

A	Correct	A school official with a legitimate educational interest.
B	Confusion set	Makes records public without consent.
C	Inverted operation	An outside party needs parent consent first.
D	Adjacent category	No educational role at all.

3. Answer A Concept 2

~~After an assembly on bike safety,~~ a sixth grader shows a teacher bruises and says a family member caused them, then asks the teacher to keep it secret. ~~The student is a strong reader.~~ What should the teacher do?

Target word: reporting duty **Decides:** A disclosure of harm creates reasonable suspicion.

A	Correct	Reasonable suspicion triggers a mandatory report.
B	Inverted operation	Teachers report; they do not investigate, which can put the child at risk.
C	Confusion set	A teacher cannot promise secrecy about suspected abuse.
D	Dropped element	The law requires suspicion, not proof.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

What level of certainty does a teacher need before making a mandatory report of suspected abuse?

Target word: reporting threshold **Decides:** Reasonable suspicion.

A	Correct	The threshold is suspicion, not certainty.
B	Adjacent category	No written statement is required.
C	Absolute language	Proof is for investigators, not reporters.
D	Confusion set	The duty belongs to the teacher personally.

5. Answer D Concept 3

An eighth grader sends a friend request to a teacher's personal social-media account. ~~The student's parent is a family friend of the teacher. The request came on a Saturday.~~ What should the teacher do?

Target word: professional boundary **Decides:** Communication with students belongs on school channels.

A	Confusion set	The channel is the problem, not the topic.
B	Adjacent category	Still a personal channel with a student.
C	Camouflage	A family link does not change the teacher-student role.
D	Correct	Protects both the student and the teacher.

6. Answer B Concept 4

At a middle school ~~that just installed a new front office system,~~ many families who speak languages other than English rarely attend conferences held at 3:00 p.m. on weekdays. What is the best response?

Target word: remove barriers and invite two-way contact **Decides:** Timing and language are the barriers.

A	Dropped element	Ignores both the language and time barriers.
B	Correct	Removes barriers and builds two-way communication.
C	Adjacent category	One-way and infrequent.
D	Confusion set	Mistakes barriers for lack of interest; deficit thinking.

7. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

Which is an example of two-way family communication?

Target word: identify two-way communication **Decides:** The school asks for and uses families' input.

A	Inverted operation	A one-way report, not a conversation.
B	Confusion set	Useful, but one-way.
C	Correct	Invites families to share knowledge.
D	Adjacent category	Information flows only from school to home.

8. Answer B Concept 5

A science teacher ~~whose school has a large garden~~ wants to work with a local water-treatment plant during a unit on water quality. ~~The plant opened 40 years ago.~~ Which plan uses the community resource best?

Target word: purposeful community partnership **Decides:** Tie the visit to unit goals with preparation and follow-up.

A	Absolute language	Well-planned partnerships enrich learning.
B	Correct	Connects the resource to learning goals.
C	Confusion set	Commercial promotion is not a learning partnership.
D	Adjacent category	An outing, not a learning experience.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A teacher's evaluation, ~~completed in a new online platform~~, rates questioning as "developing" because most questions ask for recall. ~~The evaluator was a former math coach~~. What is the best next step?

Target word: act on feedback with a SMART goal **Decides:** The goal must be specific, measurable, and time-bound.

A	Adjacent category	Not targeted to the questioning feedback.
B	Correct	Specific, measurable, and time-bound, tied to the feedback.
C	Inverted operation	Resists the feedback instead of using it.
D	Dropped element	Not measurable and has no timeline.

10. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

A teacher's growth goal reads, "Increase student discussion in my classes." What does it most need to become a SMART goal?

Target word: find the missing SMART element **Decides:** No measure and no deadline.

A	Confusion set	Approval does not make a goal SMART.
B	Absolute language	It is neither measurable nor time-bound.
C	Adjacent category	Adds detail but not a measure or timeline.
D	Correct	Without them, progress cannot be tracked.

11. Answer C Concept 7

A lesson on ratios, ~~taught on a rainy Monday~~, went poorly: most students could not solve the final problems. ~~The teacher's room was recently repainted~~. What is the most useful reflective step?

Target word: evidence-based reflection **Decides:** Student work shows where learning broke down.

A	Inverted operation	Blames students instead of examining the teaching.
B	Dropped element	Skips the analysis.
C	Correct	Uses evidence to change practice.
D	Adjacent category	Hands reflection to someone else.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A general education teacher ~~with 15 years of experience~~ receives a student's IEP requiring guided notes and extended time on assignments. The teacher feels it is unfair to the other 28 students. What must the teacher do?

Target word: legal duty to implement **Decides:** IEP accommodations are legally binding in every covered setting.

A	Confusion set	They apply in every setting the plan covers.
B	Adjacent category	The duty does not depend on co-teaching.
C	Correct	Every teacher named in the plan must implement it.
D	Dropped element	The plan covers assignments too.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	11	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Confidentiality of student records	Student education records may be shared without parent consent only with school officials who have a legitimate educational interest, plus a few legal exceptions.	Sharing grades with volunteers, other parents, or outside adults because they seem trustworthy.	Someone asks a teacher about another student's grades or records.
2	Mandatory reporting	Teachers must report reasonable suspicion of abuse or neglect promptly to the designated authority; they do not investigate or wait for proof and cannot promise secrecy.	Calling the family first, promising confidentiality, or waiting for more evidence.	A student discloses harm or shows signs of it.
3	Professional boundaries	Keep communication with students on school-approved channels and in a professional role, including online.	Accepting personal social-media contact because it seems harmless or the family approves.	A student reaches out on a personal account or app.
4	Two-way, accessible family engagement	Effective engagement invites families' knowledge through two-way communication and removes barriers such as time, language, and format.	Relying on one-way messages and reading low attendance as low interest.	Families who seldom attend school events.
5	Community resources tied to learning goals	Community partners and resources are used well when they are tied to learning goals with preparation and follow-up.	Treating a community visit as a stand-alone treat, or accepting commercial promotion.	A teacher planning a partnership or outside visit.
6	Turning evaluation feedback into a SMART goal	Use evaluation feedback to set a Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound goal and track evidence toward it.	Writing vague goals ("ask better questions") or signing up for unrelated training.	An evaluation rating followed by "what should the teacher do next?"
7	Reflective practice uses evidence	Reflection starts with evidence of student learning, finds where it broke down, and changes practice.	Blaming students or circumstances, or waiting for an evaluator to point out problems.	A lesson that did not go well.
8	IEP and 504 plans bind every teacher	Accommodations in an IEP or 504 plan are legally required in every setting they cover, including general education classrooms.	Treating accommodations as optional or unfair to other students.	A general education teacher reluctant to follow a plan.

Course scope (public description): Teaching in Middle School prepares students to effectively teach in middle school environments by exploring key roles and responsibilities of middle level educators. The course focuses on understanding and applying ethical standards, creating inclusive and culturally responsive learning environments, and utilizing family and community engagement to support diverse learners. Teaching in Middle School examines how to leverage technology and community resources to enhance teaching practices and foster collaboration. Through the analysis of teacher evaluation feedback and reflective practice, Teaching in Middle School provides strategies for continuous professional growth. By the end of the course, students will be equipped to create supportive, developmentally appropriate, and engaging middle school classrooms that promote academic, social,

and emotional growth in learners.